

KEREM AKIN

akinkerem717@gmail.com • Harrisonburg, VA 22801

QuestBridge Prep Scholar — College Match Finalist Candidate — Engineering Track

Rising senior at Spotswood High School with a record of academic excellence across three countries (Turkey, UAE, USA). QuestBridge Prep Scholar seeking full-scholarship College Match placement in an engineering program at an Ivy League or top-25 university. Selected for Virginia Governor's School for STEM (full scholarship), Rose-Hulman Operation Catapult (60% scholarship), and advancing to TSA Nationals — while pursuing self-directed work in game development, chess, and piano.

EDUCATION

Spotswood High School – Rockingham County, VA, USA Aug 2025 – Jun 2027 (expected)
Grade 11–12 • GPA: 4.139 weighted / 4.00 unweighted • All A's across AP/Honors/DE coursework • National Honor Society Member

– **Junior Year (Grade 11, completed — all A's):** AP English Language, AP Physics 1, DE Pre-Calculus; plus Chemistry II Honors, Biology II Honors, US History II Honors

– **Senior Year (Grade 12, scheduled):** AP Physics 2, AP Chemistry, AP Statistics, AP Computer Science A, AP Gov, AP World History, AP English Literature, DE Calculus — 7 APs + 1 DE

Dubai British School Emirates Hills (DBSEH) – Dubai, UAE Aug 2023 – Jul 2025
IGCSE/GCSE • All 8s & 9s across all subjects • Outstanding-rated school, top 5% in Dubai • Distinction* in BTEC IT

Horizon International School (HIS) – Dubai, UAE Aug 2021 – Jul 2023
Interschool chess representative • Basketball team

Primary & Middle Schools – Ankara, Türkiye 2015 – 2021
Consistently top 1% GPA across all years

STANDARDIZED TESTING

SAT: 1410 (Mar 2026), retaking Aug 2026 **AP:** 4 & 4 (Physics 1, Eng Lang) **GCSE:** All 8s & 9s (= A/A*)

HONORS & AWARDS

- **QuestBridge National College Admissions Conference** — Invited to attend in person; exclusive QB program for top Prep Scholars (2026)
- **TSA Webmaster** — 2nd Place, Virginia; National finalist — Top 10 in the USA, TSA Nationals, June 2026
- **National Honor Society** — Member, Spotswood High School, 2025–present
- **College Board National Recognition Program** — Rural and Small-Town Recognition Award (2026)
- **UKMT Intermediate Mathematics Challenge** — Gold Award, Best in School (Dubai, 2024)
- **Certificate of Achievement** — Year 11 Maths Super League, Dubai, November 2024
- **Mental Mathematics** — Top in School, Horizon International School (Dubai)
- **UKMT Junior Mathematics Challenge** — Gold Certificate, Best in School (2022) • Junior Mathematics Olympiad (2022)
- **National Assessment Ranking** — 1st among 16,000 students, Turkey (2020)

COMPETITIVE PROGRAMS & SUMMER INSTITUTES

- **Virginia Governor's School for STEM** — Full scholarship; selective 3-week residential program at the University of Lynchburg (about 100 students selected from across Virginia); coursework incl. "The Dark Night Sky — Serious Questions for Real Astronomers" (college-level astronomy & astrophysics) (July 2026)
- **Rose-Hulman Institute of Technology — Operation Catapult** — Residential 2-week engineering program — led a 2-person team; designed and built a working catapult from scratch; 60% merit scholarship (June 2026)
- **Sabancı University Residential Program** — 2-week program: Machine Learning & AI, Python, Quantum Physics, Industrial Engineering (July 2024)

EXTRACURRICULAR ACTIVITIES

- **TSA (Technology Student Association)** — Video Game Design team lead; Webmaster, Engineering Design & On Demand Video competitor
- **Self-Taught Pursuits** — Game development in GameMaker/GML (built advanced 2D game); Chess (1,100+ Elo; HIS interschool tournament 2023); Piano (Grade 5–6 repertoire; performed at HIS & DBSEH school shows); Rubik's Cube (sub-45 sec)
- **Sources of Strength** — Peer Leader (peer support & mental-health leadership program), 2025–present
- **Sports** — Basketball: 5 years; HIS secondary team (2023) • Football & Table Tennis
- **Volunteer Math Tutor** — Tutored primary-school students in mathematics (Dubai, 2023)
- **Official SAT Peer Tutor (College Board)** — Volunteer tutor for up to 10 peers in a 4-week College Board bootcamp (2026)

SKILLS & LANGUAGES

Languages: Turkish (Native) • English (Native) • Spanish (GCSE 9/9) • Arabic (Beginner)

Technical: Python • GameMaker (GML) • Unity • Microsoft Office Suite (Excel, Word, PowerPoint, Teams)

Attributes: Self-directed learner • Analytical & detail-oriented • Composed under pressure • Globally adaptable (3 countries)